OpenMuscle starter kit: cheat sheet

Day one, in order. Allow about an hour the first time, mostly waiting for the install and for charging.

1 Charge · 2 Switch on · 3 Install · 4 Start · 5 Wi-Fi · 6 Heatmap · 7 Camera · 8 Record · 9 Train · 10 Predict · 11 Send back

Why this exists

OpenMuscle is a low-cost, open-source wearable that predicts finger movement from your muscles. Each FlexGrid band has **60 pressure-sensing cells** that feel the pressure of the muscles under them (not their electrical signals). While you move, your computer's camera watches your fingers and the software learns the link; afterwards the band alone predicts your finger movement. It aims at reliable finger curl and grip force, not joint-by-joint precision. The bands use **Wi-Fi only** (no Bluetooth). Everything runs on your own computer; recordings stay on it until you choose to send them.

You need: 2 FlexGrid bands, the USB-C cable, a computer with a camera, Chrome or Edge, internet (once), and 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi with its password or a phone hotspot.

OpenMuscle is a research prototype. It is not a medical device and must not be used to diagnose, treat or monitor any condition or to make any medical decision. TO CONFIRM = not yet checked on a real band or computer.

THE BAND What is on the board

The letters are used again in steps 1 and 2

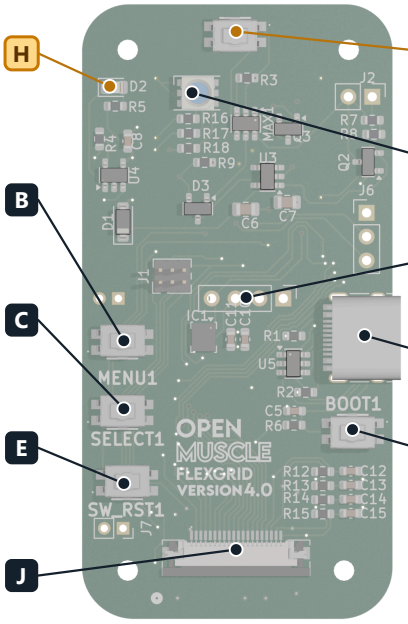
CHRG light (tiny, D2) (H)
The charger's own light: believe it for "is it charging". Its color: TO CONFIRM

MENU (printed MENU1) (B)
Tap: status page, again for page 2, then the live grid. Hold 2 s: charge mode.

SELECT (printed SELECT1) (C)
Tap: pause or resume sending (Wi-Fi stays on).

SW_RST1 (download mode) (E)
For reflashing a stuck band: hold it while pressing BOOT. Leave it alone in normal use.

Sensor connector (J)
The flat tail of the sensor sheet slots in here.



Power button (SW_PWR1) (F)
Short press: on. Short press again: off.
Press feel: TO CONFIRM

Status light (G)
Faint glow when powered, dark when off.
Color plus pattern: see page 2.

Screen connector (I)
The optional screen plugs in here. Kit bands ship without it.

USB-C (A)
Charges the band. Plug in for Wi-Fi setup. Readings go over Wi-Fi.

BOOT (printed BOOT1) (D)
Restarts the band (chip reset). Nothing else.

■ Dark badge: confirmed from the design files.
□ Amber badge: one detail not yet seen on a real band (TO CONFIRM).

3D render of the V4 board, the side facing away from your skin (the blue dome is not a lit state). **Hold MENU and SELECT together for 3 s** to forget the Wi-Fi and return to WIFI SETUP (magenta blink; let go early to cancel). Buttons do nothing while the band shows WIFI SETUP.

1 Unbox and charge

- Plug the supplied USB-C cable into the band and a USB power source. **Charge both bands while you do steps 3 and 4.** Charge and running times are not measured yet. TO CONFIRM
- Trust the tiny **CHRG light** (H) for "is it charging"; the status light only guesses that USB is plugged in.
- **Charge mode** (hold **MENU** 2 s) charges faster, but only once the band has joined your Wi-Fi (after step 5); tap SELECT or unplug to leave it. On USB it can start by itself after 5 minutes: normal.

Stop using a band whose battery looks swollen or damaged.

2 Switch on

- Use the **power button** (F, top edge): a short press switches on, a short press again switches off.
- Whether a press while USB is plugged in switches it off is not checked yet. TO CONFIRM
- A powered band always shows a **faint glow** (white or yellow); **dark means switched off**. The glow shows your press worked.
- **Keep USB plugged in for Wi-Fi setup (step 5):** on battery alone the band cannot start its setup network.
- A new band on USB blinks blue. **Kit bands have no screen:** the setup Wi-Fi name and password are on the band's sticker. Two quick blinks, then a pause, is normal.

REFERENCE The status light: color plus pattern

Read both. Orange and amber are the same color: steady = working, blinking or pulsing = trouble.

- **Blue, one blink a second.** `WIFI SETUP` (step 5).
- **Blue, two quick blinks, pause.** Setup, on USB. Normal for a kit band: read the sticker.
- **Blue, steady.** Joining your Wi-Fi, up to 20 s.
- **Green, steady for 2 s.** Joined: `WIFI OK`.
- **Brief pulse every 3 s.** Waiting for the computer. Role color: ● ● ● ○ left, right, labeler, none.
- **Orange, steady.** Sending data: the normal light. A short cyan flash every 5 s: USB plugged in.
- **Cyan, slow breathing.** `PAUSED`. Tap SELECT to resume.
- **Dark.** Switched off. Press the power button; the faint glow shows it is on.
- **Faint glow, always.** Powered on, under every pattern; dark means switched off.
- **Purple, slow pulse, never dark.** `CHARGING`, Wi-Fi off. Tap SELECT or unplug to leave it. Steady purple: full (the band's own estimate).
- **Green, breathing.** `RECORDING` to an SD card (hold SELECT 2 s; only if your kit has one TO CONFIRM), Wi-Fi off. Tap SELECT to stop.
- **Amber, one blink a second.** `LOW BATTERY`: plug in.
- **Amber, slow pulse, never dark.** `WIFI LOST`: the band reconnects by itself.
- **Amber, fast blink.** `WIFI FAILED` and why. Back at WIFI SETUP in 30 s, same name and password.
- **Red, fast blink.** Recovered from a crash; clears after 60 s of normal running.

Strips run left to right in time. Two blinks with a fitted screen that stays blank: needs repair. Dim blue breathing: switching on. Magenta blinking: MENU and SELECT held. Only the faint glow and no blue blink in setup: plug the band into USB. When two things are true at once the band shows one light: crash recovery and the button-hold colors come first, and paused, charging or recording hide the low-battery and Wi-Fi-lost lights. Case visibility: still being checked TO CONFIRM.

REFERENCE The screen (only if your band has the optional screen)

Examples only.



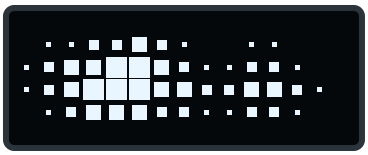
Setup. Top line alternates with "see guide". Name wraps; password after PW.



Status 1. Tap MENU. Also shows for 15 s after joining.



Status 2. Tap MENU again. A rough battery percent. HUBS = computers receiving.

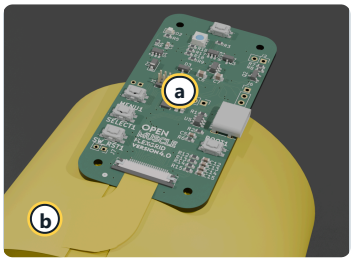


Live grid. Normal running; a bigger mark means a harder press. A quick sensor check.

Four lines of 16 characters. PAUSED, CHARGING and RECORDING stay on the screen until you leave that mode. LOW BATTERY repeats every 5 minutes; WIFI FAILED (with its reason) and NO SD CARD appear briefly. How readable the screen is in a case or sleeve is still being checked TO CONFIRM.

REFERENCE Wearing it

TO CONFIRM The placement wording below is not yet confirmed by the hardware owner.



Render. The sheet's real color is not confirmed TO CONFIRM.

ⓐ **The circuit board faces away from your skin**, so you can see the light and reach the buttons and the USB-C socket (and read the screen, if fitted).

ⓑ **The sensor sheet (the flexible side with the grid of cells) goes against bare skin**, never over a sleeve. Left band on the left forearm, right band on the right, long side along the forearm, elbow toward wrist.

- **Where:** the thicker, muscular part of the forearm, a hand-width or two below the elbow crease, centered on the bulge when you make a fist. Not the bony wrist or the soft elbow.
- **How tight:** snug, not tight: one finger slides under the strap and your fingers move freely. A deep mark after ten minutes, or a tingling or cold hand: loosen it.
- **Same place every time**, or the score drops. Mark two skin-safe pen dots just outside the band's edge. If it slips during a recording: stop, fix it, start a new recording.

3 Install the software

once, about 5 to 10 minutes; Chrome or Edge, Python 3.10 or newer, internet needed

At github.com/Open-Muscle/OpenMuscle-Software click **Code**, then **Download ZIP**. Extract the **whole** zip (Windows: right-click, Extract All; Mac: double-click); never run the installer from inside it. Open the extracted folder, then **installers**.

Windows. Open **windows**, double-click **Install-OpenMuscle.bat**. A blue "Windows protected your PC" window: **More info**, then **Run anyway**. If Python is missing, tick **Add python.exe to PATH** on the python.org page and run it again. At **Add the firewall rule now? (Y/n)** press Enter, then Yes. Wait for "OpenMuscle is installed."

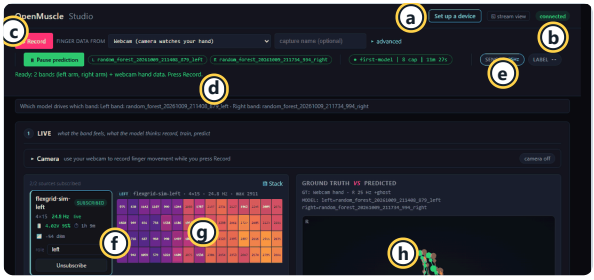
Mac (macOS 12 or newer) TO CONFIRM Open **macos**, double-click **install.command**. "Unidentified developer": right-click it, Open, Open again. If it asks for Python, install it from python.org and run it again.

Linux. In a terminal in the extracted folder run `bash installers/linux/install.sh`. If it prints a firewall line (such as `sudo ufw allow 3140:3141/udp`), copy it into the terminal.

Running an installer again is safe and never touches recordings.

4 Start the Studio

- Double-click **OpenMuscle** on the Desktop (Linux: applications menu). A black window opens: **leave it open**, closing it stops OpenMuscle. On Windows do not click inside it (press Enter or Esc if the page stops updating).
- If the computer asks to let OpenMuscle or Python receive network connections, choose **Allow** (Windows: keep **Private networks** ticked). A Mac also asks to find devices on your local network: Allow, or bands will not appear. Keep the laptop plugged in and awake while recording.
- Your browser opens `http://localhost:8000`, the **OpenMuscle Studio** (else paste that into Chrome or Edge; if 8000 is busy, use the address the black window prints). **No band found yet.** is normal until step 5.



(a) **Set up a device** (e) **SENSOR** rate in Hz
(b) **connected** badge (f) **role** menu
(c) **Record** (then **Stop**) (g) Band **heatmap**
(d) The **Ready** line (h) Camera hand view

Practice data. **Help**, beside **Set up a device**, is not in this picture.

5 Put each band on your Wi-Fi once per band; the Studio sends it over the USB cable

1. **Plug in.** Plug the band into your computer with its USB cable and keep it plugged in until it joins. Use the kit cable: some cables only charge and the band is never found.
2. **Open the wizard.** Studio: **Set up a device**, **I am ready**, **A band**.
3. **Find the band. Plug the band into this computer** shows a green tick and **Found Band**. Its last six characters match the sticker. Two bands plugged in? Choose one, or unplug the other.
4. **Your Wi-Fi.** The name is filled in from this computer's Wi-Fi (2.4 GHz only); type the password. **Send to the device**. The computer stays on its Wi-Fi.
5. **All set.** After about 20 s Finish shows **All set** and the band shows green for 2 s. For band two click **Send the same Wi-Fi details**.

Your Wi-Fi must be 2.4 GHz, password only (no username), no web sign-in page, not a guest network, and the computer on it too. Otherwise use a phone hotspot (iPhone: **Allow Others to Join**, **Maximize Compatibility**; Android: 2.4 GHz).

> **No answer?** Unplug the cable and plug it back in (or press BOOT), then try again. **No cable that carries data?** Click **Use the band's own Wi-Fi instead** and follow the OM- steps in the guide. **Typo?** Click **Start over with this device**. **Privacy:** on your computer the password stays in this browser tab only and nothing is sent online; the band keeps it in its own memory until you hold MENU and SELECT for 3 s (also how to move a band to another network, or to erase it before you return a band).

6 See the heatmap squeeze test

- Put the band on as on page 2. Each band gets a card and a heatmap: set its **role** menu to **left** or **right** for that arm. With two bands the arms must differ or **Record** is blocked.
- **Squeeze test, before every session.** Relaxed, the grid is mostly dark or a quiet color. Press firmly with a fingertip, then slowly make a fist: pink, orange and yellow cells that fade as you relax. A region that never changes is not touching skin: refasten. Bright at rest: too tight.

7 Turn on the camera

- Open the **Camera** bar, press **Start camera**, choose **Allow** (the first time needs internet once, for the hand tracker).
- Hold your hand up, palm toward the camera, fingers visible, in bright even light: a green skeleton follows it.
- Under **Record** the line should read *Ready: 2 bands (left arm, right arm) + webcam hand data. Press Record.* If it gives a reason instead, fix that first.
- No video is saved, only joint positions. No camera: **No labeler** keeps band data but cannot train a model.

8 Record eight short takes about 15 minutes

- Press **+ session**: name `first-model`, a made-up participant code such as `P01`, Arm: the band's arm (**Both arms** for two bands), Finger data from **Webcam**, then **Start session**. **Do not move a band** until the last take; if you must, start again.
- **Two bands, one camera:** its one hand supplies the finger data for both bands. Move both hands together, same movement at the same time, one in front of the camera. In **More details** set **Mirrored** to **Yes, labels measured on the left hand** (or right), the hand the camera watches. Or wear just one band, on that arm.
- **Every take: 30 seconds, never under 10.** Press **Record**. **First 5 s: hand completely still and relaxed**, so the model sees "no movement". Then the movement, slow and smooth, until about 0:30. Press **Stop**, read the card, press **Record next take**, then **Record**.

Good	Nothing wrong found.
Check	Usable; hover for the reason.
Bad	Better redone; do not tick it for training.

hand lost, **labels missing**: keep your hand in view. **idle labeler**: move more. **weak signal**: band not touching; adjust it and restart from take 1. **too short**: aim for 30 s. Then record that take again.

8 The eight takes slow beats fast; a capture name such as 01-open-close is optional

1 and 5: open and close
Open the hand wide, close to a loose fist, repeat: 8 cycles of about 3 s.

2 and 6: single fingers
Curl each finger toward the palm and straighten it, twice each: thumb to little (about 5 s each).

3 and 7: grips
Fist, pinch (thumb to index), point (index straight, others curled), then repeat once. Each: close 1 s, hold 2 s, open 1 s, rest 1 s.

4 and 8: free mix
Any mix of the above, with short rests. The last one or two takes are kept aside to test the model.

Takes 5 to 8 repeat 1 to 4 in order at your natural pace. In a hurry: skip takes 4 and 7.

9 Train

1. In **Data & Models** (or press **Go to Train**) tick your eight takes; do not tick any take marked **Bad** (untick it if Go to Train ticked it). Leave **Learn the whole hand (big model)** unticked: it makes a large model and only draws a 3D hand.
2. Press **Train**. Allow about 4 to 5 minutes per band; two bands train one after the other. Do not close the page.

You get a result card per band: one bar per finger (green 50% and over follows well, amber 25 to 49% partly, red barely) and a **What to do next** line: do that one step. **Could not train yet** says what to change.

The score words

Good 75%+	Follows your fingers well. Try it live.
Fair 50%+	Follows the big movements. Record more takes, one finger each; train again.
Weak 25%+	Picks up a little. Check the fit; record a rest take and slow single-finger takes.
Not working yet	Under 25%. Check the fit and the camera view; record new takes.
Not tested yet	Record a longer take with finger movement.

The score is on takes the model never trained on (100% = perfect). One take alone can score at most Fair: use at least two.

10 Watch it predict

- If the result card says **Prediction starts automatically** it is running; otherwise press **Predict** (**Pause prediction** stops it). In **Ground truth vs Predicted** the green hand is what the camera sees; a line under it reads out what the model thinks each finger is doing, from the bands alone, as a percent of curl (0% straight, 100% fully curled).
- **Good:** the percentages follow your fingers with a short delay and fall to near 0% when you relax. **Bad:** they barely move or jump about while you are still, or it went wrong after the band moved. Fix: wear the band the same way, record more varied takes, train again. **This model may not match.** means train a new one.

11 Your files, and what to send back

- Everything is on your own computer, in a folder called **OpenMuscle** in your home folder. Nothing is uploaded. **Data & Models** shows it (**Open folder**, **Copy path**). The camera picture is never saved. **Back up** after each recording day, with OpenMuscle closed: copy captures, sessions and models to an external drive.
- **To send recordings:** in **Session** click **Export session** (or tick takes, then **Export selected**). Leave **Include full raw streams** and **Include my notes** off unless asked. Click **Download zip**: it lands in Downloads, with a copy in **OpenMuscle/exports**. Models are never included. Many email services refuse over about 20 MB: export one session at a time.
- **Keep private:** the list linking codes to people (outside the OpenMuscle folder), raw streams, notes and models. Treat recordings as personal data.

If something goes wrong Help (top right of the Studio), then Troubleshooting; Run the check first names the likely cause

No band found yet	Band joined (green light; WIFI OK on a screen)? Computer on the same 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi (not guest, VPN or OM-)? Firewall, the usual cause on Windows: allow private networks (UDP 3140 and 3141, if IT asks). Wait 30 s, then **Add a device by IP address**, **Scan subnet**. Restart the band.
Heatmap flat or all bright	All dark: not touching skin, refasten. Bright at rest: too tight. Badge says disconnected: keep the black window open and reload.
Record will not start	The line beside it says why: set left or right in each **role** menu, or switch the camera on.
Camera blocked or busy	Camera icon in the address bar, Allow. Close Zoom, Teams and other tabs using the camera.
Train grayed out	Tick at least one take, or read the message (too little recording, band not touching, or finger data that never moved).
Still stuck	**Still stuck** in Troubleshooting shows how to make a short report: add `--report` to the line **Run the check first** gives. It never holds Wi-Fi names, passwords or recordings; do not attach recordings or put anyone's name in it.

Practice data: the Studio's practice mode. Kit bands have no screen: use the sticker. Designs: CERN-OHL-S-2.0. Firmware and software: MIT.